

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS

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THE DETERMINING FACTORS OF THE EVENTS AND OUTCOME OF OUR LIVES.

OUR TEXT

Ecclesiastes 9:11

11 I returned, and saw under the sun, **that the race is not to the swift, nor the battle to the strong, neither yet bread to the wise, nor yet riches to men of understanding, nor yet favour to men of skill; but time and chance happeneth to them all.** KJV

Ecclesiastes 9:11

11 I have seen something else under the sun: **The race is not to the swift or the battle to the strong, nor does food come to the wise or wealth to the brilliant or favor to the learned; but time and chance happen to them all.** NIV

Ecclesiastes 9:11

11 I returned and saw under the sun that **the race is not to the swift nor the battle to the strong, neither is bread to the wise nor riches to men of intelligence and understanding nor favor to men of skill; but time and chance happen to them all.** [Psalms 33:16-19; Romans 9:16.] AMP

Ecclesiastes 9:11

The Limitations of Wisdom 11 Again I saw under the sun **that the race is not to the swift, or the battle to the strong, or bread to the wise, or riches to the discerning, or favor to the skillful; rather, time and chance happen to all of them.** Holman

Ecclesiastes 9:11

11 I have observed something else under the sun. **The fastest runner doesn't always win the race, and the strongest warrior doesn't always win the battle. The wise sometimes go hungry, and the skillful are not necessarily wealthy. And those who are educated don't always lead successful lives. It is all decided by chance, by being in the right place at the right time.** NLT

Ecclesiastes 9:11

Time and Chance 11 I also saw something else here on earth: **The fastest runner does not always win the race, the strongest soldier does not always win the battle, the wisest does not always have food, the smartest does not always become wealthy, and the talented one does not always receive praise. Time and chance happen to everyone.** NCV

1.THE RACE is not for the swift,

The fastest runner does not always win the race,

2.THE BATTLE *nor is the battle to the strong,*

the strongest soldier does not always win the battle,

3.THE BREAD - *neither yet bread to the wise,*

The wisest does not always have food,

The wise sometimes go hungry,

Neither is bread to the wise hungry,

4.THE RICHES - *nor yet riches to men of understanding, or wealth to the brilliant –*

nor riches to men of intelligence and understanding,

the smartest does not always become wealthy,

5.THE FAVOUR - nor yet favour to men of skill;

or favor to the learned; -

nor favor to men of skill; -

And those who are educated don't always lead successful lives,

And the talented one does not always receive praise –

6.BUT TIME AND CHANCE - happen to them all

but time and chance happen to them all. [Psalms 33:16-19; Romans 9:16.]

rather, time and chance happen to all of them.

It is all decided by chance, by being in the right place at the right time.

TIME & CHANCE

Chance

the occurrence of events in the absence of any obvious intention or cause.

do something by accident or without intending to.

Chance - the uncertainty of what is going to happen - the unpredictable

WE ARE AND NOT THE MANAGERS OF OUR OWN DESTINY OR FUTURE regardless of how knowledgeable or wise we are.

All things do not play out according to the normal processes that we would expect.

It is logical for us to think:

That the fastest runner wins the race or the strongest soldier wins the battle, or the wise is never hungry, or the smartest person has riches, and the skilful man will find favour

And it is also logical thinking that the factors of time and chance that are a part of the outcomes listed above.

BUT THIS IS NOT SO.

BECAUSE THERE IS GOD WHO IS INVENTIVE AND CREATIVE, AND THAT INTERVENES AND ORDERS THE AFFAIRS OF MAN.

THE MESSAGE HERE IS THAT ONLY GOD DETERMINES THE ULTIMATE OUTCOME OF WHAT HAPPENS TO OUR LIVES – NOT TIME AND CHANCE OR THE WISDOM, SKILLS, INTELLIGENCE OF MAN, AND NEITHER DOES TIME AND CHANCE.

OUR TIMES AND LIVES ARE COMPLETELY IN GOD'S HANDS

*Psalms 31:15 **My times** are in your hands; deliver me from my enemies and from those who pursue me..." NIV*

*Psalms 31:15 "**My future** is in your hands. ..." NLT*

*Psalms 31:15 "**My life** is in your hands...." NCV*

*Psalms 90:10 **Our lifetime** is seventy years or, if we are strong, eighty years. But the years are full of hard work and pain. They pass quickly, and then we are gone. NCV*

*Psalms 90:10 **Seventy years are given to us!** Some even live to eighty. But even the best years are filled with pain and trouble; soon they disappear, and we fly away. NLT*

It is not the devil, it is not this world's perverseness, it's not man's wisdom or skill and it is not chance or favourable times that determines the events or outcome of our lives; IT IS OUR HEAVENLY FATHER AND SOVEREIGN GOD THAT DOES EXACTLY WHAT PLEASE HIM according to his army in heaven.

*Daniel 4:35 And all the inhabitants of the earth are accounted as nothing. And **He does according to His will in the host of heaven and among the inhabitants of the earth**, and none can stay His hand or say to Him, What are You doing? AMP*

*Daniel 4:35 All the people of the earth are nothing compared to him. **He does as he pleases among the angels of heaven and among the people of the earth.** No one can stop him or say to him, 'What do you mean by doing these things?' NLT*

God is Sovereign over all the schemes of the devil and the wickedness of the generation that we live in and that is why we need to stop attributing life's events to chance and man's efforts

Yes, time and chance are an integral part of those things we face in life, BUT they are not the determining factor - GOD IS

THEREFORE, we need to be constantly practicing the acknowledging of that truth for our lives.

THE MESSAGE HERE IS THAT ONLY GOD DETERMINES THE ULTIMATE OUTCOME and destiny of the events of our lives.

Amen – Ps Barry